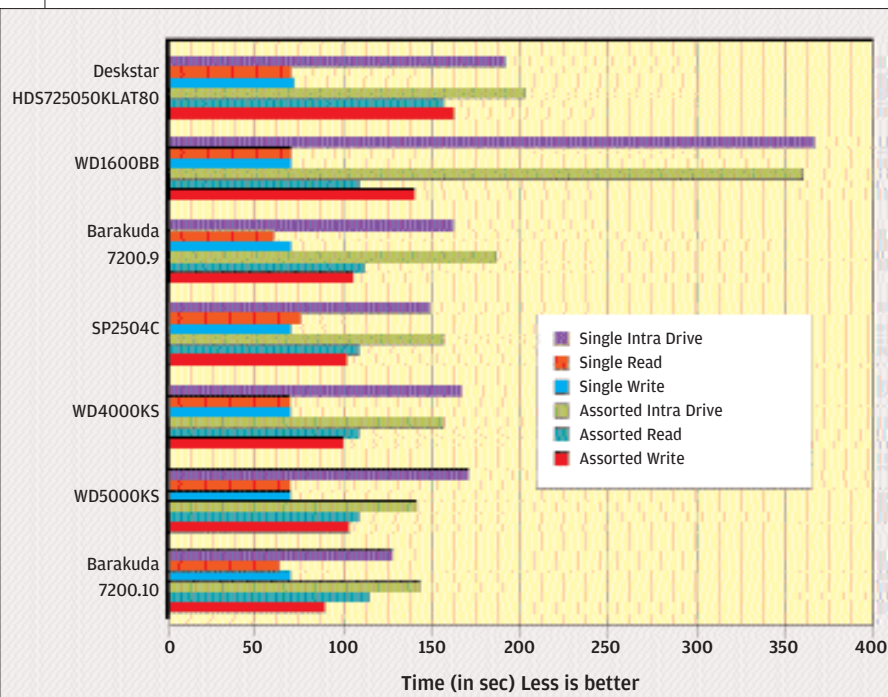




WD4000KS and WD5000KS. All these three broke the sub 1 minute barrier.

The slowest drive in this test was once again a PATA drive, Samsung's SP0411N, and was, surprisingly, joined by a SATA sibling (the HD160JJ).

Throughout our tests, we also noted which drives ran hotter than the others, as is regular practice. We do not note these scores unless we come across something highly irregular or unusual. It's interesting to note that the blazing-fast Seagate drives also ran the hottest throughout the tests, with the SATA drives in particular generating quite a bit of heat. Temperatures remained well within check however—not a serious problem—but it does add to the heat circulating inside your cabinet, especially when you have multiple drives. The WD drives seemed the coolest in general, with the Samsung and Hitachi drives falling in between.

Purchase Decisions

Getting yourself a new hard disk can be a daunting task, especially with all the options out there, both brand-wise and size-wise. As mentioned earlier, Serial ATA is an established technology now, with very tangible

benefits over Parallel ATA. Though SATA drives are slightly more expensive than their PATA counterparts, the extra cash spent is well worth the performance gains. SATA cables are also much sleeker; PATA cables are notorious airflow restrictors and dust magnets.

Instead of going the traditional "more cash, bigger drive" way, we've tried to distinguish between users on the basis of what they actually need, and not what they can afford. After all, it's your requirements and not your wallet that defines you as a user! We've given you a convenient little box full of goodies (in the form of buying decisions) to make that choice just a little easier!

And The Winners Are...

Serial ATA (250 GB And Below)

In this, the category comprising the smaller SATA drives (250 GB and smaller), we were most impressed by the performance of the 250 GB Samsung SP2504C. It's also very competitively priced at Rs 4,200, and we deem it worthy of the *Digit Best Buy Gold* award. The *Digit Best Buy Silver* award goes to the Seagate ST3250824AS, another 250 GB drive. This drive lost out on the Gold because it's just a little more expensive, and also because it trailed the SP2504C in many of the tests by just a bit.

Serial ATA (Above 250 GB)

The drive that most impressed throughout all our tests was the Seagate Barracuda 7200.10 750 GB. However, it actually belongs in a class of its

the much faster SATA drives. If you do not have Serial ATA support on your motherboard, this is the hard disk for you!

The single 4 GB .rar file test was once again owned inside-out by the 750 GB heavyweight from Seagate, followed, albeit by a large margin, by its 250 GB sibling. The other drive that was quite impressive here was the 500 GB Hitachi SATA, with a time of 157.6 seconds in the Internal singlefile transfer test. The WD 120 and 160 GB PATA models brought up the rear in this test. If you look closely at the table, you'll see the fastest drive is nearly three times faster than the slowest drive. While we cannot in all fairness compare the latest SATA drive with much older PATA models, this proves that hard drives on the whole are becoming faster with every new release. Each revision adds performance and subtracts from the price (well, most of the time, anyway).

Next, we ran the gamut of file and application loading benchmarks. Two drives from Seagate really shone while loading Photoshop—the quickest was the Seagate Barracuda 7200.9 series 250 GB (7.3 seconds), followed by the 750 GB (8.1 seconds). The Samsung SP2504C was also very good here, scoring within a second of the leaders.

The mammoth 1 GB Photoshop .PSD file test was interesting because it saw a new leader emerge, a hard drive that had earlier escaped the limelight. The 500 GB Hitachi SATA (the Deskstar HDS725050KLA360) simply blew away all but two drives, the Western Digital siblings, the

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Seagate 250 GB
ST3250824AS

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Western Digital 400 GB
WD4000 KS

Contact Sheet		Inkjet MFD		
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Hitachi	Cyberstar Infocom Ltd	9341057327	lalit.sudrik@cyberstarindia.com	www.hgst.com
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